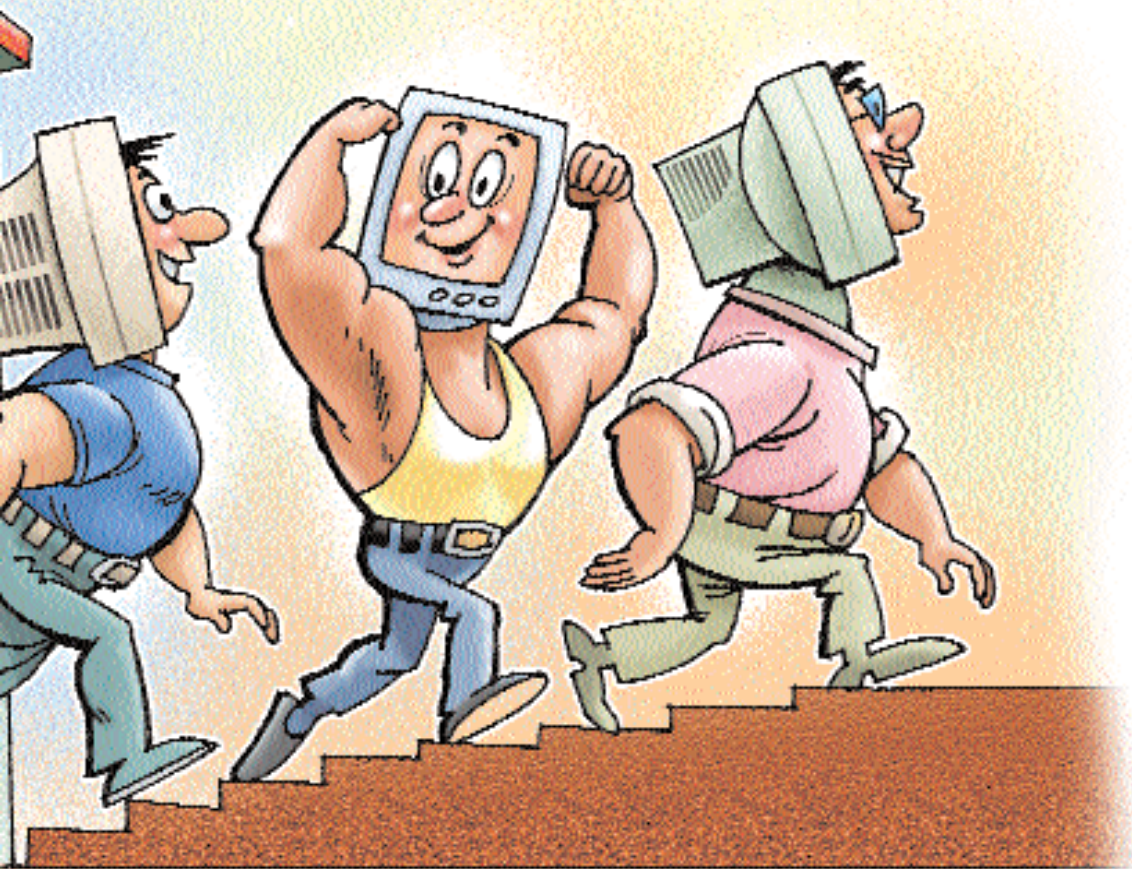




Is a new PC better?

Ah, the all-important question! What you need to consider here first are the kinds of applications you use. If you use your system simply for working in Word or spreadsheets, you don't really need an upgrade as your present configuration ought to be enough.

However, you would need an upgrade, or a brand new PC, if you want to run the latest applications. Recent applications like Photoshop 6 demand greater system resources. So first decide on the applications you want to run, and then come down to the configuration.

If your present PC configuration is anything lesser than a Pentium II 233 MHz, don't bother upgrading. It is cheaper and easier to get a new PC. The reason is that most of the components like EDO RAM needed for upgrading these systems are hard to find in the market. And even if you do find components, they are likely to be second-hand and overly priced. Systems below the P-II 233 MHz mark cannot be upgraded beyond a certain level, thus limiting the potential for one more upgrade in the future.

In this case also, the minimum configuration worth upgrading depends on the applications you run. For example, Pratik Shah, a Mumbai-based graphics designer, recommends a P-III 550 with 128 MB RAM and a 15-inch monitor as the minimum configuration worth upgrading—from a designer's point of view, of course.

back. Consider it the upside of the industry being down. But this doesn't mean that you have to go out and buy a PC. The idea is that with a few upgrades you can make your PC as healthy as ever, as good as any new PC.

However, if your PC's configuration is way too old or your applications demand more power than can ever be achieved from upgrades, then you would have no choice but to buy a new one. Take a look at the side bar: Is a new PC better? before you make a decision.

We'll consider the configurations which call for a completely new PC further on in the article. Now let's see why it sometimes makes sense to boost your existing machine than go in for the latest PC.

In the current market situation, it may be better to wait and watch as there is a lot of ambiguity as far as the different platforms for processors are concerned. It seems almost every other day some major chip manufacturer comes up with a new chip architecture that requires a